

Size matters

11 dSLRs put through their paces. Which one will catch your eye?

The all-rounders

We test all-in-one PCs from Apple, Dell, HP, Lenovo and Zenith

Bazaar

We test some of the latest gadgets and gizmos of the tech world

The case in point

20 cabinets (₹2,000 - ₹7,000) face off against each other to help you get the right fit



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After selecting the core components of your rig, the next important decision is selecting the right cabinet to house them. Five years back, the person who assembled your PC gave you the

most affordable cabinet along with a power supply. The situation now is completely different.

Cabinet selection is given as equal importance as the rest of the components, since a cabinet with poor air flow, poor build and no wire management features won't help in the longevity of your core components. Cabinets as a product category

vary in price range – from the sub-thousand rupee cabinets to ones over ₹25,000. Based on the user queries we receive, we concluded that most of the buying happens in the under-₹7000 price bracket. So we called for cabinets within this price range from around six brands and got around 20 of them. Here are the test results.

₹2,000 – ₹4,000

Cooler Master Elite 335

CM Elite 335 has a mesh design on the front frame while the lower half of the frame has ventilation cutouts on the edges. Clean and simple design is the mantra. The side panel has a bulging grill section which has the air guide on the inner side to direct the air out from the CPU cooler section.

The cabinet is quite spacious even for an ATX board. HDD and ODD bay trays are fixed and have the clip-lock mechanism to hold the drives in place. An Ideal case for those on a budget and are willing to spend some money on custom fans.

Circle UberCool

This looks like an ordinary cabinet except for the two red fans on the top portion. There's a fan controller with two USB ports on the side. The side panel has no fan section or provision to add a fan, but there are circular openings to let the air out. On opening the cabinet, you'll find a single fixed HDD and ODD bay frame. There's very little space to play around with after you've lodged an ATX board. There's some space on the side of the

HDD bay frame where you can manage some unruly wires.

Also, we found the tray to bend in places – a sign of poor build. The base of the cabinet has minor rubber pads for absorbing vibrations. There's a dust filter under the base of the cabinet around the PSU section.

Cooler Master Elite 371

Cooler Master Elite 371 is a mid-sized tower built with ventilation in mind as the front portion is covered in mesh. This cabinet has no front fan but has a rear fan. There's a provision to add two fans on the top. The case is quite solid and we didn't notice any bending of the metal on the motherboard tray. However, there's little space to move around after an ATX board has been placed. The HDD and ODD bays have click locks.

ePRO Dragon

At first glance, this cabinet looks like an out and out gaming cabinet, but what's surprising is its low price point. The front frame has a black and red plastic design with neat spaces exposing the mesh section it hides. The side panel has a large 240 mm fan and a honeycomb grill on the outside. The cabinet interiors are grey. The HDD bay is detachable to help you in conveniently setting up your system and managing wires. Both, the HDD and ODD bays have a toolless click-lock mechanism for the drives. For a cabinet this economically priced, the build quality is quite sturdy. It's ideal for gamers on a budget.